

ROAD TO SEPTEMBER 9 · EDITION 10

EDITION 10 · 1 DAY TO SUBMISSION · TUESDAY 8 SEPTEMBER 2026

Day Zero

*Tomorrow the countdown ends.
Nothing else does.*

ONE DAY. THEN THE FRAMEWORK.

EXECUTIVE SNAPSHOT

Tomorrow the submission window closes. This final edition is not a recap and it is not a farewell. It is a map of the morning after: five things that begin on September 10, each with a provision behind it, and none of them optional. The countdown was always the easy part. What it counted down to is an operating framework, and the framework does not have a last day.

WHAT BEGINS ON SEPTEMBER 10

- 1. The review.** Everything filed goes under the Commission's reading. From September 10, your filing is no longer your document. It is your company's opening statement in a long conversation, and it will be read against every report you send afterwards.
- 2. The annuity.** Regulation 20 derives the annual contribution to the Decommissioning and Abandonment Fund from the approved cost estimate. The estimate you filed becomes a payment rhythm. It reprices as the estimate reprices, and it does not pause.
- 3. The outturn record.** Regulation 15(1)(b)(iii) requires licensees to report actual cost incurred as decommissioning proceeds. Year on year, the Commission accumulates reality against the estimates it approved. The gap between what you filed and what you spend will eventually be a number on the regulator's desk, computed from your own returns.
- 4. The public ledger.** Regulation 18 obliges the Commission to maintain a database of installations, structures and pipelines, published on its website annually. It has not appeared yet. The day it does, every operator's inventory position becomes publicly checkable, by anyone, without asking.
- 5. The unfinished clocks.** The suspension provisions in Regulations 5(9) and 5(10), and the twelve-month onshore application clock in Regulation 5(12), keep running as if the deadline never happened. Edition Eight named the owners these clocks need. If they were not named before the filing, name them now.

THE BOARDROOM QUESTION

The filing is in. Who owns what it committed us to, from tomorrow morning?

STRATEGIC IMPLICATION

There are deadline companies and there are rhythm companies. A deadline company staffed a sprint, filed a document, and went back to what it was doing. A rhythm company read the same Regulations and saw a permanent operating cadence: contribute annually, report actuals, watch the public ledger, keep the clocks owned. The Regulations were written for the second kind. From September 10, the Commission will be able to tell the difference from the paperwork alone.

AFTER THE ROAD

This series began in July with a simple premise: that the Regulations rewarded the operators who read them early, and that a weekly brief could put the reading in front of the people who sign. Ten Tuesdays later, the premise held. The provisions did the arguing. The countdown did the urgency. The readers did the rest.

The daily Day Zero brief continues every morning, tied to real incidents and the same discipline of citation. The road ends here. The work it pointed at is just beginning, and Day Zero will be reading alongside you.

DAY ZERO INSIGHT

A countdown measures the distance to a date. The framework governs everything after it.

The plan you filed is now the standard your outturn will be read against.

The road ends at September 9. The obligations were never on the road.

EXECUTIVE CHECKLIST

- Filing acknowledged and archived with every annex, as submitted.
- Regulation 20 contribution entered into the forward budget cycle.
- Actual-cost capture live from the first invoice, in the form Regulation 15(1)(b)(iii) will demand.
- A standing diary note on the Regulation 18 public database and the section 86(b) accreditation criteria.
- One named owner per clock, confirmed in the first board pack after submission.

CLOSING NOTE

To every reader who carried these ten editions into a boardroom, forwarded one to a colleague, or picked up the phone because of a provision quoted here: thank you. The road does not end at September 9. Neither does Day Zero.